If you're already comfortable with JavaScript, Python, or Java, then we suggest reading Chapter 1, Getting Started, on page 3, which talks about installing and running Ruby, followed by the introduction in Chapter 2, Ruby.new, on page 17. From there, you may want to take the slower approach and keep going with the tutorial that follows, or you can skip ahead to the details starting in Part III, followed by the library reference in Part IV.

Experts, gurus, and "I-don't-need-no-stinking-tutorial" types can dive straight into the language reference in Chapter 24, Language Reference: Basic Types and Expressions, on page 431, skim the library reference, and then use the book as a (rather attractive) coffee coaster.

Of course, nothing is wrong with just starting at the beginning and working your way through page by page.

And don't forget: if you run into a problem that you can't figure out, help is available. For more information, see *Appendix 1, But It Doesn't Work!*.

Resources

Visit the Ruby website at http://www.ruby-lang.org to see what's new. You can find a list of community resources, including the official mailing list and Discord server, at https://www.ruby-lang.org/en/community.

And we'd certainly appreciate hearing from you. Comments, suggestions, errors in the text, and problems in the examples are all welcome. Email us at rubybook@pragprog.com.

If you find errors in the book, you can add them to the errata page at https://devtalk.com/books/programming-ruby-3-2-5th-edition/errata. If you're reading the PDF version of the book, you can also report an erratum by clicking the link in the page footers.

You'll find links to the source code for almost all the book's example code at https://www.pragprog.com/titles/ruby5.

With all that out of the way, let's start learning about Ruby.